BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

28 October 2026



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Japan Semiconductors

Advantest Corp

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

6857.JP **45,800 JPY**

Advantest 2Q27/3: CPU renaissance drives SoC tester TAM 50% CAGR

Advantest is our top pick long within our earnings preview and it was indeed a big beat and raise.

Another beat. Revenue came in at ¥477.7bn, +30% QoQ and beating consensus by 11%, above our preview. GPM and OPM were strong at 71.7% / 55.9%. Net income at ¥193.3bn beat consensus by 21%. SoC tester was up 36% QoQ, and memory tester revenue was up 11% QoQ. **FY guidance raised.** Top-line was revised up 8.7% to ¥1.86tn from ¥1.71tn, and their new OP guidance is ¥967bn (¥846bn prior).

Growth rate for SoC testing was softly guided as "showing no signs of slowing down from the current ATE CAGR of >50%", and 2026 TAM was guided to be near the upper end of guidance range at $11.5bn. **Capacity target** of 5,000 units was said to be already achieved, and they are pulling forward their 10,000 unit target well ahead of the previously guided schedule of FY29/3. As the next milestone, company hinted at doubling it again to 20,000 units without providing a timeline. They are also accelerating memory tester capacity ramp up to be in line with SoC testers.

By application, the biggest incremental factor was CPUs which is said to be seeing strong demand due to agentic workload. We previously highlighted CPU as one of our biggest thesis in Advantest: From GPU to CPO, CPU, LPU... Upgrading to Outperform and Top Pick, and management confirmed this view, identifying CPUs as the third pillar. They commented that 1. although test time is not as large as GPU / ASICs but is not small either; 2. CPU-to-GPU ratio for inferencing is going up as well. **As for CPO,** CEO guided it has long test time, and will double / triple each year to reach $1bn market, but played it down saying it is still smaller in size compared to a $11bn TAM market that is already growing at 50% CAGR.

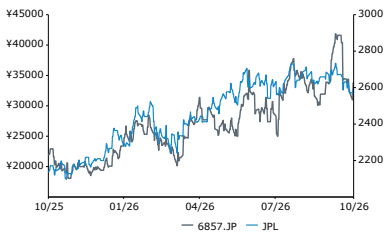
In terms of market share, company seemed confident to gain share this year as well as next year, targeting 70% in SoC without specifying a timeline. Company said customers where they have incumbency are expanding, as well as gaining market share where they were not incumbent. They seem to also command dominant market share in CPU — for both x86 and Arm, and said they are agnostic to whichever player gains more share. *(continued)*

Close Date	28 Oct 2026
6857.JP Close Price (JPY)	34,930
Price Target (JPY)	45,800
Upside/(Downside)	31%
52-Week Range	41,990/17,765
JPL	2,591.52
FYE	Mar
Div Yield	0.2%
Market Cap (JPY) (B)	25,568.76
EV (JPY) (B)	25,263.80

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	77.9	3.6	17.4	92.8
JPL (%)	17.5	(3.0)	5.9	21.2
Relative (%)	60.4	6.5	11.5	71.6

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Reported EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
6857.JP (JPY)	513.30	948.96	1,088.87

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	1,129*	1,763*	2,116*	--

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Reported P/E (x)	68.0	36.8	32.1

*Values shown in billions;Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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Margins. 2H OPM was guided to be lower than 1H (50.1% vs. 54.0%) due mainly to higher component cost — especially DRAM — as they said to have used up their cheaper inventory in 1H. Company is trying to counteract the margin pressure by repricing their products through new configurations / licensing.

Future data points include the timeline for reaching 10k capacity and 2027 tester TAM which will be updated in Q3 earnings. Also, company will update their MTP4 in Q4, which will likely encompass their financial targets up to FY30/3, as well as their 2026 market share. Company also holds a IR fireside chat for which the focus will be on their supply chain strategy on 12th November.

Outperform. At this time, we are reviewing the new data points from the company. We keep our PT of ¥45,800 with 31% implied upside. **We reiterate** Outperform on Advantest.

Investment Implications

We rate Advantest Outperform (PT ¥45,800).

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DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: **Advantest Q2: Results summary**

Advantest Q2 FY27/3 results		Actual Q2 FY27/3	Delta vs. Bernstein	Delta vs. Cons.	Growth YoY Actual	Growth YoY Cons.
Revenue	Actual	477.7	9.5%	11.1%	81.7%	63.5%
	Bernstein	436.2				
	Consensus	430.0				
Gross profit	Actual	339.8	12.6%	13.8%	107.7%	82.5%
	Bernstein	301.8				
	Consensus	298.6				
Gross margin	Actual	71.1%	1.9%	1.7%	8.9%	7.2%
	Bernstein	69.2%				
	Consensus	69.5%				
Operating profit	Actual	266.8	20.7%	22.1%	146.0%	101.5%
	Bernstein	221.1				
	Consensus	218.6				
Operating margin	Actual	55.9%	5.2%	5.0%	14.6%	9.6%
	Bernstein	50.7%				
	Consensus	50.8%				
Net profit	Actual	193.3	19.8%	20.5%	142.7%	101.4%
	Bernstein	161.4				
	Consensus	160.4				
Earnings per share	Actual	266.23	20.2%	25.1%	144.9%	95.9%
	Bernstein	221.55				
	Consensus	212.87				

Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 2: **Advantest Q2: Segment summary**

Results Breakdown	Actual Q2 FY27/3	Growth YoY	BERNe Q2 FY27/3	Delta	Consensus Q2 FY27/3	Delta
Total revenue	**477.7**	**81.7%**	**436.2**	**9.5%**	**430.0**	**11.1%**
Testing Systems	**436.7**	**83.9%**	**400.9**	**8.9%**	**401.9**	**8.7%**
SoC Testers	**353.3**	**103.4%**	**326.0**	**8.4%**	**323.0**	**9.4%**
Memory Testers	**53.4**	**21.6%**	**49.0**	**9.1%**	**54.6**	**-2.3%**
Services and others	41.1	60.4%	35.3	16.4%	34.2	20.1%
Total OP	**266.8**	**146.0%**	**221.1**	**20.7%**	**218.6**	**22.1%**
Testing Systems	**264.8**	**133.1%**	**221.3**	**19.7%**	**215.2**	**23.1%**
Service, support and others	12.3	3497.4%	5.8	111.4%	6.6	86.8%

Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 3: **Advantest Q2: FY guidance summary**

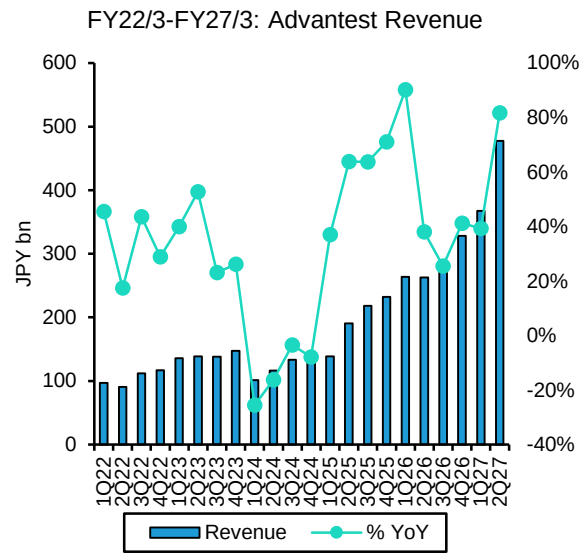
Guidance Breakdown	Guidance FY27/3E	Prev. Guidance FY27/3E	Delta	Bernstein FY27/3E	Delta	Consensus FY27/3E	Delta
Revenue	**1,863.0**	**1,714.0**	**8.7%**	**1,763.1**	**5.7%**	**1,754.0**	**6.2%**
Operating profit	**967.0**	**846.0**	**14.3%**	**897.7**	**7.7%**	**889.5**	**8.7%**
OP Margin	51.9%	49.4%	2.5%	50.9%	1.0%	50.7%	1.2%
Net Income	**741.5**	**660.0**	**12.3%**	**691.4**	**7.2%**	**685.5**	**8.2%**
Net Profit Margin	39.8%	38.5%	1.3%	39.2%	0.6%	39.1%	0.7%

Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Q2 FY27/3 EARNINGS SUMMARY IN CHARTS

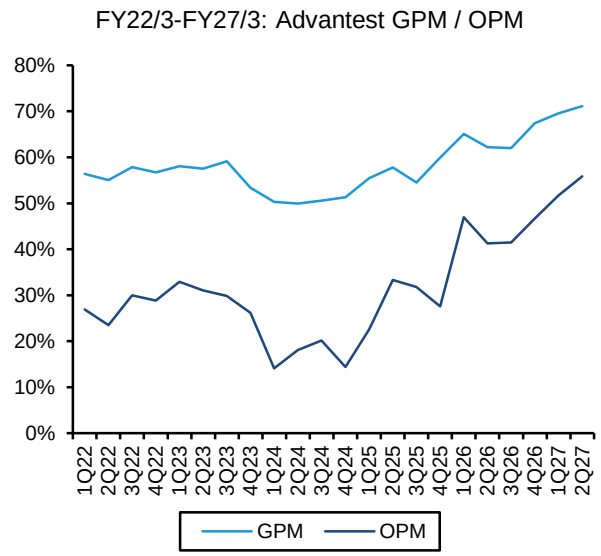
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EXHIBIT 4: **Advantest revenue in Q2 was ¥477.7bn, +81.7% yoy**



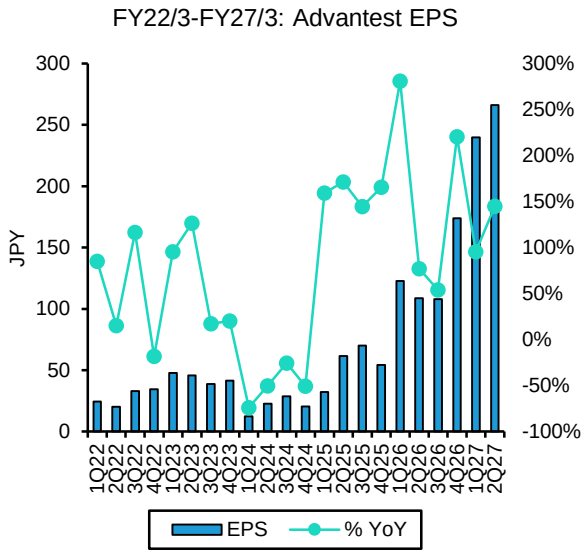
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 5: **Advantest Q2 GPM / OPM was 71.1% / 55.9%, +1.6% / +4.2% QoQ respectively.**



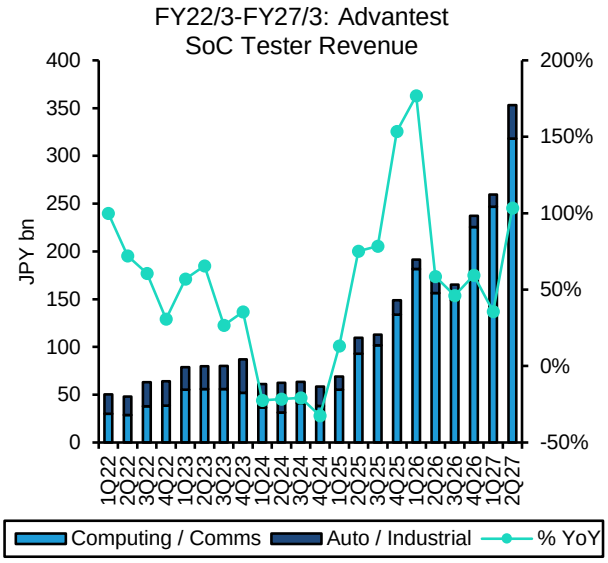
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 6: **Advantest Q2 EPS was ¥266.23, up +145% yoy.**



Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

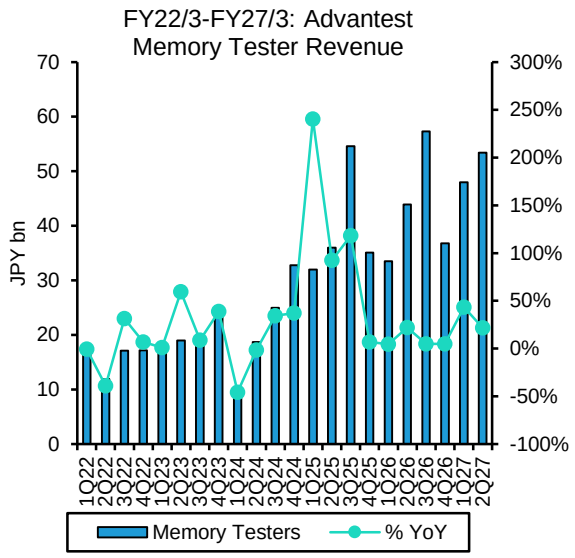
EXHIBIT 7: **Q2 SoC revenue was ¥353.3bn, up +103% YoY.**



Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

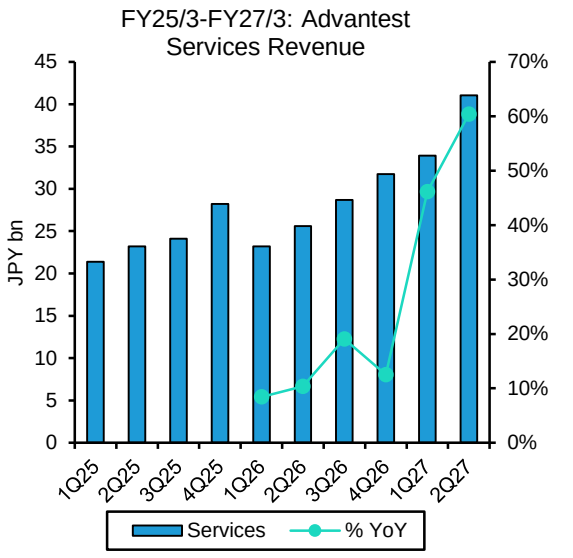
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EXHIBIT 8: **For memory, Q2 was at ¥53bn, up +21.6% yoy.**



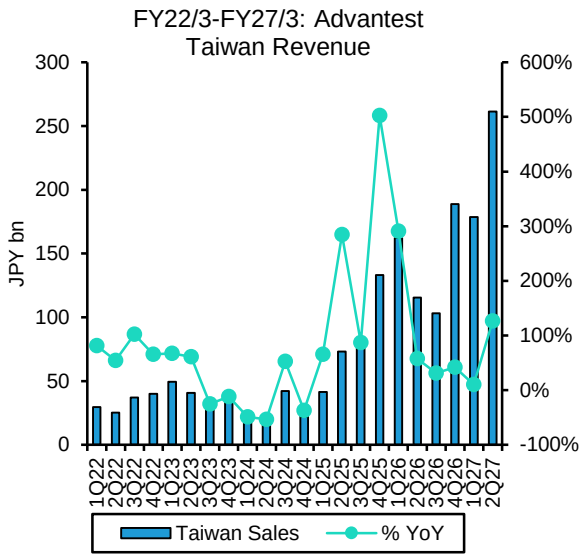
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 9: **Q2 services sales were ¥41.1bn, up +60% yoy.**



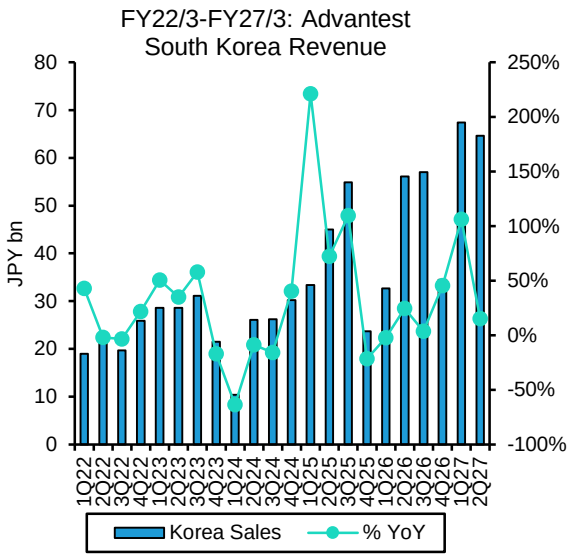
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 10: **Q2 sales to Taiwan was ¥261bn, up +126% yoy.**



Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

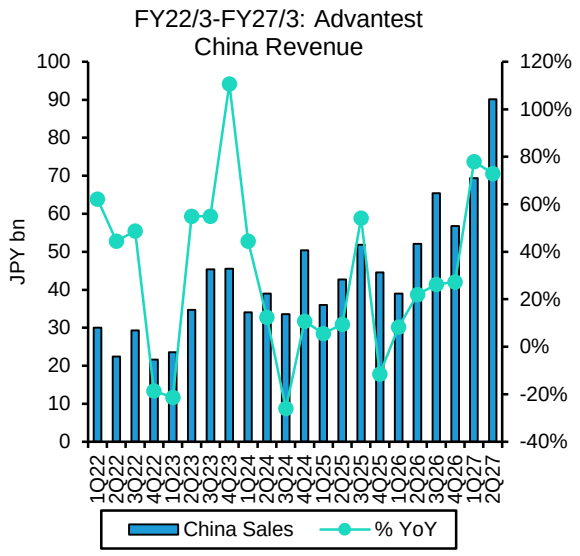
EXHIBIT 11: **Q2 sales to South Korea was ¥64.6bn, up +15.2% yoy.**



Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

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EXHIBIT 12: **Q2 sales to China was ¥90.1bn, up +73% yoy.**



Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

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BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			28 Oct 2026		TTM	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Closing Price	Price Target	Rel. Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
6857.JP (Advantest)	O	JPY	34,930	45,800	71.6%	JPY	513.30	948.96	1,088.87	68.0	36.8	32.1
JPL			2,591.52									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Advantest Corp

We set a price target of ¥45,800 using a P/E multiple of 40x against our forward Q5-Q8 EPS estimate.

RISKS

Advantest Corp

There are a number of downside risks to our Advantest target price: (1) End demand of AI-related production such as GPUs and HBM resulting in both multiple and earning power fluctuations (2) Changes in competitive environment (3) Exchange rate fluctuation.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-15 pp
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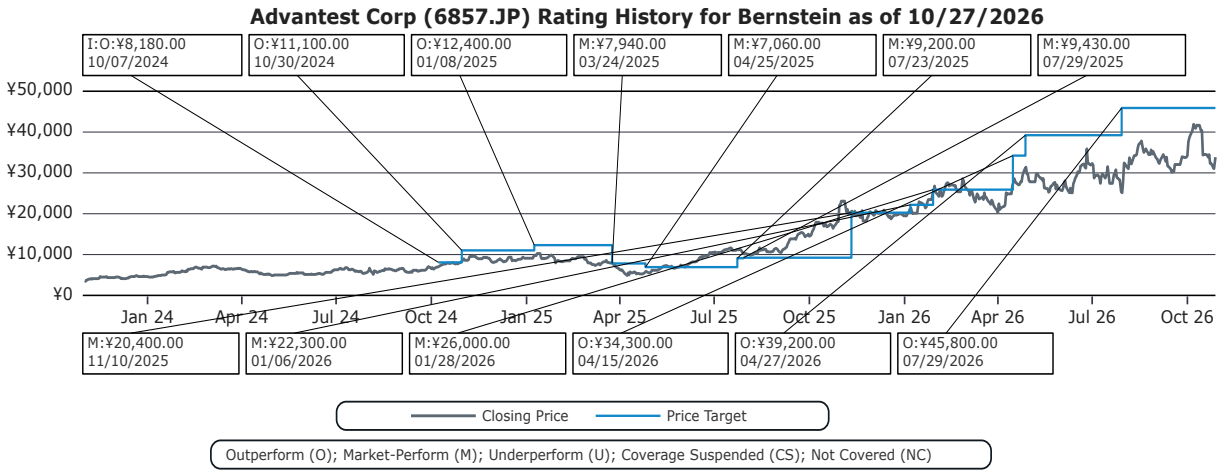
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Outperform	BUY	52.3%	14.2%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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